

Think about something you happily spend money on now that you wouldn't have ten years ago. Now jot down three things that you might spend money on ten years from now, even though you don't today.

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

Buying a House Isn't Always a Great Investment

You've probably heard common phrases like "You're throwing money away on rent!" or "Don't pay your landlord's mortgage!" But buying a house isn't always a good financial decision. Owning has extremely high "phantom costs," including closing fees, property taxes, maintenance, and interest. In many cases, you'll make much more money by renting and investing the difference. (This is exactly what I do. I rent by choice and invest, which also lets me have more flexibility and zero maintenance. I told you earlier, I really hate Home Depot.)

Of course, you should always run the numbers and decide what's best for you. And remember: Making a large financial decision isn't always solely about the math. It can be perfectly fine to make decisions for status, safety, comfort, or purely because you want to.